

VATSIM MINNEAPOLIS ARTCC – DES MOINES ATCT/TRACON

LETTER OF AGREEMENT

EFFECTIVE: August 3, 2026

SUBJECT: Terminal Area Control Service

- 1. PURPOSE:** This agreement between Minneapolis Center (ZMP) and Des Moines ATCT (DSM) delegates airspace and associated air traffic control responsibilities and supplements the procedures in FAA Order 7110.65 and 7210.3.
- 2. CANCELLATION:** vZMP-DSM LOA, dated March 17, 2020.
- 3. SCOPE:** The responsibilities and procedures contained herein and applicable to all aircraft operations controlled by Minneapolis Center and Des Moines ATCT.
- 4. RESPONSIBILITIES:** DSM is delegated responsibility for providing air traffic control services to aircraft operating 10,000 feet MSL and below within ZMP's airspace, as depicted on Attachment 'A'.
- 5. PROCEDURES:** Unless otherwise coordinated, the following procedures shall apply:
 - a. Aircraft to DSM Approach Control. ZMP must:
 - (1) Clear arrivals 11,000 MSL and above to descend and/or maintain 11,000 MSL.
 - (2) Ensure arrivals landing within DSM Approach Control Airspace and overflights below 10,000 feet MSL, are at or climbing / descending to their final altitude (excluding any aircraft descending through the top of DSM Approach Control Airspace).
 - (3) Release control to DSM Approach Control for:
 - (a) Turns not to exceed 45 degrees from the transferring sector. DSM Approach must make pointouts resulting from a turn.
 - (b) Descent on aircraft landing within DSM Approach Control airspace.
 - (c) Beacon code changes.
 - b. Aircraft to ZMP. DSM must:
 - (1) Climb departure aircraft to 10,000 feet MSL, or final altitude if lower.
 - (2) Clear IFR overflights to ZMP, below 10,000 feet MSL, to maintain their final altitude. Aircraft may be climbing or descending to their final altitude without manual coordination. Any altitude change after a RADAR handoff is initiated must be manually coordinated.
 - (3) Descend Creston, IA (CSQ), and Jefferson, IA (EFW), arrivals to 4,000 feet MSL.
 - (4) Release control to ZMP for:
 - (a) Turns up to and including 45° on all aircraft. DSM will be responsible for internal coordination.

(b) For descent on arrivals to the following airports:

- Creston, IA (CSQ)
- Jefferson, IA (EFW)
- Mason City, IA (MCW)
- Hampton, IA (HPT)
- Decorah, IA (DEH)
- West Union, IA (3Y2)
- Forest City, IA (FXY)

(c) Beacon code changes.

- (5) Ensure that departures exiting DSM airspace south of the DSM230 radial are established on their flight plan route or given a heading to ensure the flight will join the route within the lateral boundaries of DSM airspace. All other departures will be established on their route or be assigned a heading to join their route.
- (6) Ensure that successive aircraft entering ZMP airspace have 5NM spacing, constant or increasing.

6. GENERAL:

- a. In the event ZMP initiates a clearance to DSM Approach Control for a departure east of the ZMP/Chicago ARTCC (ZAU) boundary to climb above 10,000 feet MSL, then ZMP is responsible for coordinating with ZAU. If DSM Approach Control requests a climb approval with ZMP east of the ZAU/ZMP boundary, then DSM Approach Control is responsible for coordinating with ZAU.
- b. Transfer of control, in accordance with the limits prescribed in this LOA, occurs at the time a RADAR handoff and frequency change to the receiving controller have been completed.
- c. Frequency Assignments:
 - (1) ZMP: As depicted in Attachments A and B
 - (2) DSM Approach:
 - (a) Controller Symbol A – 135.2
 - (b) Controller Symbol D – 123.9
 - (c) Controller Symbol S – 120.45
 - (d) Controller Symbol W – 118.9

7. ATTACHMENTS:

1. Attachment A: DSM sector delegated airspace, frequency assignments, and fixes.
2. Attachment B: ALO sector delegated airspace, frequency assignments, and fixes.

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